

Question:
At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

- A. visual system
- B. thalamus
- C. frontal lobe
- D. brain stem
- E. parietal lobe
- F. cerebellum
- G. cortex
- H. basal ganglia
- I. hypothalamus
- J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

</tool_call> reasoning process here

At birth , the brain undergoes rapid development , with certain regions developing earlier than others . While the brain stem , hypothalamus , and other subcortical structures are present and functional from birth , the most complex and highest-level cognitive functions are mediated by the cerebral cortex , particularly the frontal lobe and association areas . The cortex , especially the prefrontal cortex , is the last part of the brain to mature , with significant development occurring during childhood and adolescence . This includes the development of executive functions , decision-making , and social behavior .

Among the options , the cortex (especially the prefrontal cortex) is the least developed at birth compared to other brain structures like the brain stem , thalamus , or basal ganglia , which are more mature and functional early on .

Therefore , the least developed part of the brain at birth is the cortex , specifically the neocortex , which undergoes extensive growth and refinement over time .

< answer >G</answer >

